m. Fishing

In the same seasons as the birds, the fish of the Bārān migrated. During these times, many fish were captured using nets and wattles (chīgh) placed in the water. In autumn, when the plant known as wild-ass-tail had matured, flowered, and produced seeds, people would take 10–20 loads of the seeds and 20–30 of green branches (gūk-shībāk) to a water source. They would break these into small pieces and scatter them into the water. Then, they entered the water and easily collected the drugged fish. At a convenient spot downstream, near a waterfall, they had prepared in advance a wattle made of finger-thick willow-withes, securing it by piling stones on its sides. The rushing water flowed through the wattle but left behind any fish that had floated down. This method of catching fish was practiced in Gul-bahār, Parwān, and Istālīf.

In the Lamghānāt, a curious device was used to catch fish in the winter. People dug a pit in the stream's bed below a waterfall, similar in depth to a house. They lined it with stones, resembling a cooking area, and built-up stones around it above, leaving only one opening underwater. Except for this single opening, there was no other way in or out for the fish, but the water flowed through the stones. This created a sort of fish-pond from which, in the winter, fish could be taken, typically 30–40 at a time. The sides of the fish-pond, apart from the convenient opening, were sealed with rice straw held in place by stones. A piece of wickerwork was drawn into the opening by its edges and gathered together, and a second piece (a tube) was inserted, fitting at the mouth but reaching only halfway into it. The fish went through the smaller piece into the larger one, from which they couldn't escape. The second piece narrowed toward its inner mouth, with the pointed ends drawn so close that once a fish entered, it couldn't turn around and had to move one by one into the larger piece. They couldn't return because of the pointed ends of the inner, narrow mouth. With the wickerwork in place and the rice straw sealing the pond, the fish inside could be easily retrieved. Even fish that had tried to escape into the wickerwork were captured because they had no way out. This unique method of catching fish was not observed in other locations.